



A convoy of Iraqi security forces in Najaf, Iraq, on Wednesday. The American military first arrived in 2003 to topple Saddam Hussein.

Meta Exploits
Data Centers
For Tax Break

This article is by Kashmir Hill,
Jesse Drucker, Eli Tan and Mike
Isaac.

Mark Zuckerberg says Meta’s A.I. push is a tremendous success. “Our investments in A.I. are accelerating every major part of our core business,” he has told investors. “Every sign that we’re seeing in our own work and across the industry gives us confidence in this investment.”

But when Meta files its taxes, it tells the Internal Revenue Service a different story. It claims that its A.I. data centers are a giant experiment that could fail, according to four people with knowledge of the company’s operations.

It does this so it can tap into a tax credit intended for research and experimentation. It’s an aggressive interpretation of the tax break, which Meta embraced to claim billions of dollars in tax credits for data center expansion.

Characterizing its A.I. data centers as experimental is “kind of wild and out there,” said Andre Shevchuck, a partner at the advisory firm BPM who specializes in the research and experimentation tax credit.

Indeed, Meta’s own accountants recognize that the strategy is on shaky legal ground. In disclosures buried in securities filings, the tech giant warns that billions in tax savings are vulnerable to being overturned by the I.R.S., in large part because of “uncertainties with our research tax credits.”

Here’s what Meta is doing: For tax purposes, the company classifies its enormous, multibillion-dollar data centers as “pilot models.”

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U.S. Pullout Leaves Iraq to Seize Its Own Future

This article is by Erika Solomon,
Falih Hassan and Eric Schmitt.

BAGHDAD — U.S. forces formally withdrew from Iraq on Wednesday, ending a two-decade military presence that stoked years of devastating bloodshed, and leaves behind a battered nation struggling to unshackle itself from its two most powerful, and now warring, allies.

After the 2003 toppling of Saddam Hussein, the brutal dictator who ruled Iraq for nearly 24 years, U.S. forces are making their second withdrawal from the country.

Trapped Between Iran
and Washington as It
Wrestles Militias

The U.S. invasion and subsequent occupation, which ended in 2011, left a country reeling from sectarian bloodletting and militant insurgencies that cost nearly 4,500 U.S. lives and killed more than 115,000 Iraqis, according to the most modest counts.

American forces returned three

years later — this time to lead the international coalition fighting the Islamic State, the jihadist force that seized swaths of Iraq and Syria and became notorious for its slaughter of Shiite Muslim Iraqis, public killings of hostages and torture and enslavement of women from the Yazidi minority.

With the end of Operation Inherent Resolve — the U.S. military’s official name for the multinational campaign against the Islamic State — the last of the 2,500 U.S. forces stationed in Iraq this year are now gone.

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HEATHER AINSWORTH FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Keeping a Story Alive

Cereese Qusba, above, and other student journalists at The Cornell Daily Sun covered allegations of rape at a fraternity house when they were first made in 2024 and led the reporting. Page A19.

Shuffled U.S. News High School List Leads to Anger and Turmoil

By MATTHEW HAAG

Few public high schools in New York rack up achievements like Jericho Senior High School on Long Island. It was no different last school year: The senior class had 21 valedictorians and 64 admission offers from Ivy League universities.

But in August, Robert Kravitz, the school district’s second-year superintendent, received a call from the distressed school board

president. Did you see the list of best high schools by U.S. News & World Report? What happened?

Year after year, the publisher had ranked Jericho as a top school in New York State and the United States, a point of pride that Dr. Kravitz had been repeatedly reminded of when he took the job. But not this time. Jericho had plummeted, tumbling thousands of spots to No. 3,959 in the country.

“I kept saying, ‘Oh, my God, what did I change?’” Dr. Kravitz

Officials in New York
Withheld A.P. Scores

said. “It’s just so stunning.” The superintendent had, in fact, not changed a thing. But there was a shift at U.S. News, the highly influential but heavily criticized arbiter of schools whose annual rankings have the power to sway property values near top-

rated schools. This year, its formula for ranking New York schools did not include data on Advanced Placement courses and scores, harming places like Jericho, which have a high rate of students who take the rigorous classes for college credit.

The omission stemmed from a dispute with the New York State Education Department, which ordered the operator of the A.P. program, the College Board, not to

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Passengers and Crew Save
Plane to Israel After Attack

Stabbing of Pilot Leads to Struggle, Plunge
of 17,000 Feet and a Saudi Landing

This article is by David M. Halbfinger,
Aaron Boxerman, Natan Odenheimer,
Adam Rasgon and Thomas Fuller.

JERUSALEM — At first, it seemed like turbulence. Then like something worse than merely rough air on the flight Wednesday from Dubai to Tel Aviv.

“The plane just started going up and down,” said Meital Zoller, a passenger on the FlyDubai plane. Soon, she said, “we started hearing screams.”

The shouts were coming from near the cockpit, said another passenger, Adam Polovincik. “We tried to be ‘cool’ for our kids,” Mr. Polovincik said in an interview.

Then the bottom dropped out. The plane, a 737, nose-dived at a sickening angle, overhead bins popped open and luggage flew out. Passengers shrieked and prayed. Many were sure they were about to die.

What is clear so far is that there was a bloody clash in the cockpit miles above the desert of Saudi Arabia, that intervention by passengers and crew members saved the day, and that the roughly 170 people aboard endured minutes of mortal terror.

One of the plane’s pilots had attacked the other and was apparently trying to crash the plane, Israeli officials and passengers said. The authorities in the United Arab Emirates, where the flight originated, and Saudi Arabia, where the aircraft touched down, have not confirmed that.

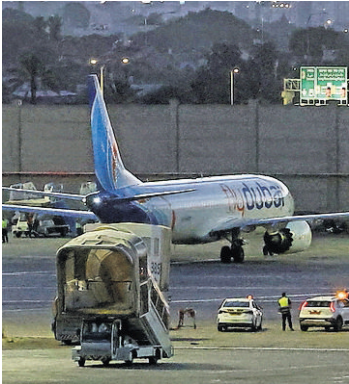
The plane plunged so sharply that the passengers, nearly all Israelis, felt pinned to their seats.

“You couldn’t move,” one passenger, Hila Gaier told Kan, Israel’s public broadcaster. “You were sucked downward.”

She turned to her two daughters and partner and told them that she loved them.

Almog Itali, another passenger, told Israel’s Channel 12, “The plane kept stabilizing and then dropping again for several long seconds.”

Flight 1073 dropped more than 17,000 feet in less than two minutes, according to data from Flightradar24. It sent a general emergency signal, then a signal of unlawful interference and then a general emergency signal again. It abruptly reversed course over northern Saudi Arabia, near the Jordanian border.



AMMAR AWAD/REUTERS

FlyDubai travelers finally made it to Tel Aviv on Wednesday.

“In my head, I said: ‘I’m so screwed, I’m so screwed. I don’t deserve to die like this,’” Peleg Itali, a 16-year-old passenger, said in an interview.

Amid the panic, a number of men rushed to the cockpit, where they found one pilot badly injured, and overcame his attacker, the other pilot, who was wielding a knife, witnesses said. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel said the injured pilot had been stabbed and had managed to open the cockpit door.

Asaf Rajuan, a passenger on the
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A.I. Detection
Helps Ensnare
Professors, Too

By MARK ARSENAULT
and ALAN BLINDER

College professors and administrators have been busting students for cheating with artificial intelligence for several years. Now, the professors and administrators are getting in trouble, too.

Dartmouth College last week announced it was investigating its provost, Santiago Schnell, after the college’s student-run newspaper found that some of his published writing appeared written by A.I.

Dr. Schnell, a mathematical biologist, is perhaps the most prominent in a growing cast of college professors and administrators who have been accused of using A.I. in a way that crosses ethical lines. There have been instances of opinion articles, research papers and even campuswide messages to students showing traces of A.I. influence. He issued a statement apologizing.

Administrators wring their hands, and sometimes issue punishments, when students outsource writing assignments to a robot to save time or avoid the hard work of thinking.

Some students are calling out the examples of faculty doing the same thing as hypocritical.

“It just goes against all the values of our institution and the concept of academia,” Eli Moyse, a Dartmouth senior, said in an interview.

A working group at George Washington University said in a

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Legal Migrants
Being Dropped
From Medicaid

By MADELEINE NGO

WASHINGTON — Thousands of refugees and other legal immigrants across the country are set to lose access to Medicaid starting Thursday as Republican-led cuts to the health insurance program for low-income people take effect.

Some of those immigrants who depend on Medicaid said in interviews that they were not sure how they would afford to treat their conditions, such as kidney failure, multiple sclerosis and bipolar disorder. Several said they applied for permanent residency more than a year ago, a status that would allow them to keep their coverage. But they said they have yet to hear back from U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services amid slowdowns in green card processing.

States across the country have warned recently that the thousands who will lose coverage include refugees, people granted asylum, people granted parole and certain victims of domestic violence. The nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office estimated that the changes would lead to roughly 100,000 more people becoming uninsured. Immigrant advocates say many of those people would instead be forced to turn to emergency rooms for care.

The cuts represent a major shift for many legal immigrants who have had access to Medicaid for decades. The government has long recognized that refugees fleeing war, persecution and other

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Pontiff Lauded in France

A visiting Pope Leo XIV received a display of reverence from a country that guards its secular identity. Page A9

Remaking Naval Warfare

Ukraine’s sea drones have evolved to act as miniature aircraft carriers, and other countries now want in. Page A5

NATIONAL A10-20

Stock-Trading Bill Blocked

A Republican effort to limit congressional stock trading, and score points with voters, faltered in the Senate in the face of Democratic opposition. Page A15

Federal Court Pauses Execution

Christa Pike was set to become the first woman executed by the state of Tennessee in 200 years. Page A17

THURSDAY STYLES D1-6

Yapping Her Way to Stardom

Ivy Wolk, an actor, comedian and provocative internet presence, is about to make her Broadway debut. Page D6

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Weird, Yes. Awkward, No.

The pop star Audrey Hobert discusses songwriting and her self-image. Page C1



OBITUARIES A21

Calypso’s Mighty Sparrow

Slinger Francisco, known as the king of the Caribbean folk tradition, was 91.

BUSINESS B1-6

Left in the Dust by A.I.

The gap between technology and the ability of governments to regulate it has gotten wider than ever with artificial intelligence, leaving a vacuum as A.I. models rapidly advance. Page B1

No Misconduct at Fed

A new report by an independent inspector general concluded that a nearly \$2.5 billion construction project was poorly managed but made no referrals to the U.S. attorney general. Page B1

OPINION A22-23

Christopher Caldwell

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SPORTS B7-10

Keeping Balance in a Circus

When it comes to Caitlin Clark, the basketball star and sociology subject, everyone wants a piece. What does she want? To play in peace. Page B7



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